



MARITIME CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

WHY CYBERSECURITY MATTERS

Cybersecurity incidents can affect vessels, waterfront facilities, safety, the environment, and operations. Many incidents begin with everyday activities that look normal at first. Your role is not to fix cybersecurity problems. Your role is to:

- Recognize unusual or suspicious activities
- Protect access and equipment
- Report concerns promptly

CYBERSECURITY THREATS VS. CYBER INCIDENTS

Cybersecurity threats are actions or situations that could put systems at risk. A cyber incident occurs when unauthorized activity actually harms systems or information.

Under U.S. Coast Guard regulations, a cyber incident is one that jeopardizes the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of information or information systems.

IT VS. OT – WHAT’S THE DIFFERENCE?

Information Technology (IT) includes systems used to store, process, and communicate information, such as email, business networks, office computers, and administrative systems.

Operational Technology (OT) includes systems that directly control physical equipment or monitor conditions that cause equipment to move or respond.

Both IT and OT systems are critical. Cybersecurity incidents affecting either can disrupt operations, create safety risks, or impact the marine transportation system.

COMMON CYBER THREATS YOU MAY SEE

Below are some common examples of cyber threats you may encounter. If something doesn’t look right, trust your instincts and report it.

PHISHING & SOCIAL ENGINEERING	MALWARE & RANSOMWARE
• Unexpected emails, texts, or phone calls • Urgent messages asking you to act quickly • Requests for passwords, access codes, or system access	• Unapproved software or pop-ups • Systems slowing down or crashing • Files becoming inaccessible or renamed
INSIDER RISKS (INTENTIONAL OR ACCIDENTAL)	OT-RELATED WARNING SIGNS (IF APPLICABLE)
• Sharing passwords or using someone else’s login • Leaving systems logged in and unattended • Connecting personal or unapproved devices	• Equipment operating without being commanded • Screens freezing or showing incorrect data • Alarms that don’t match field conditions



HOW ATTACKERS BYPASS SECURITY

Many cyber incidents do not start with hacking tools — they start when someone is tricked, rushed, or allowed physical access that bypasses standard security safeguards.

CREDENTIAL MISUSE	PHYSICAL ACCESS & PORTABLE MEDIA
- Stolen or shared passwords - Asking someone to log in for them - Using unattended, logged-in systems Never log in for someone else!	- Unknown or unapproved USB drives - Unauthorized laptops or tools - Equipment connections without approval Physical access can bypass digital security controls.
INSIDER RISKS (INTENTIONAL OR ACCIDENTAL)	OT-RELATED WARNING SIGNS (IF APPLICABLE)
- Pretending to be vendors, IT, inspectors, or supervisors - Using real names or job titles - Creating urgency to avoid verification Being polite does not mean skipping verification!	- Propping open secure doors - Disabling security features to save time - Using shared or generic accounts Shortcuts increase cybersecurity and safety risk.

WARNING SIGNS SOMETHING MAY BE WRONG

Report any of the following immediately—when in doubt, treat it as suspicious and report it:

- Systems or equipment behaving unexpectedly
- Unknown devices, cables, or USB drives connected
- Login failures with correct credentials
- Screens freezing, flickering, or showing incorrect information
- Requests to access systems outside normal procedures
- Loss of system communication
- New alarms or alerts without explanation

WHAT TO DO IF YOU NOTICE SOMETHING

1. Stop and pause
2. Do not investigate or try to fix the issue yourself
3. Report immediately

If you see something unusual, report it right away. You will never get in trouble for reporting a concern that turns out to be nothing.

Report to:

1. Supervisor / Operations Lead
2. Facility / Vessel / Company Security Officer (FSO / VSO / CSO)
3. IT ServiceDesk
4. Cybersecurity Officer (CySO)

**IF YOU SEE
SOMETHING, SAY
SOMETHING!**